

Asia Quantitative Strategy

Gen AI in Asset Management: Chat with Co-founder & CEO of Writer - Key Takeaways & Replay



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For the third session of our Gen AI in Asset Management Innovator Series, Season 2, we hosted May Habib, CEO & Co-Founder of Writer. In this short note, we present key takeaways from the session. For replay - [click here](#). For previous sessions, see - [Perplexity replay](#) and [Aiera replay](#).

Writer, an Enterprise AI platform for agentic work: With WRITER's end-to-end platform, teams can build, activate, and supervise agents that are grounded in their company's data and fueled by WRITER's enterprise-grade LLMs. It works with a third of the top 2000 companies globally with customers like JPMorgan Chase, Goldman Sachs, Vanguard, Franklin Templeton and more. Writer's value proposition extends beyond its proprietary Palmyra models into agent harness, Enterprise Brain, Playbooks, enterprise connectors and embedded governance that turn model intelligence into scalable business workflows. Wealth and Asset management and CPG are their highest growth verticals.

Writer's core differentiation: **1) Standardized and Scaled Agents:** They call these as 'Playbooks' which allow enterprises to turn fragmented, manually coordinated processes into reusable and increasingly autonomous workflows. Agents can be triggered by events or scheduled, execute multiple tasks and involve human reviewers only where needed, moving AI from an employee productivity tool towards an enterprise workflow execution layer. **2) Enterprise Brain** is the enterprise knowledge and context layer captured through organizational policies, products, communication standards and working practices. This information is automatically made available to agents, reducing the need for employees to manually attach instructions or invoke separate compliance processes. **3) Specialized Agent Harness** incorporates domain-specific knowledge about tool selection, execution preferences, workflow sequencing, related tasks and business-language conventions. **4) Built-in Governance & Compliance Framework** to create supervised (rather than unchecked) autonomy linked with compliance rules and regulations with in-built approval system. **5) Writer's flagship model, Palmyra X6:** The model has been trained on production work such as sub-agents call, grounding and retrieval, MCP/tool use, content generation, brand and voice, image analysis/generation, presentation creation, and model/system awareness. Palmyra X6 shows improvements on all nine tasks over Opus-class models with average \$0.12 cost per finish task. The model is also able to work non-stop for 8hrs on a single objective, unattended. Do note, users do get the optionality to chose other frontier models as well through Writer if that is what Enterprises choose. **6) Token Economics & Observability:** Overall, their model is 9.4x cheaper than Claude Opus 4.8 with \$3.5 blended cost per million tokens for a typical 3:1 input to output mix. Cost efficiency comes from lower token usage enabled by the specialized harness, which understands typical workflows, required tools and task sequences. More importantly, users can track token usage per playbook, the number of times a playbook has been run and hence the total tokens & costs being used with the capability to delete or kill redundant usage. **7) Create your own voice ie. AI sounds more human-like:** Writer supports a nested voice architecture ranging from corporate voice to individual employee voices. This helps AI generated content sound less like AI and more like the user or the organization.
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Key takeaways from fire-side chat: 1) Writer's pricing: Writer charges a platform access+ token based pricing with clear visibility on utilization and cost at the individual agent or Playbook level. For deployment of roughly 150–200 users, the Writer investment could be around US\$500K–US\$1 million, depending on use cases and the degree of agent autonomy. **2) Enterprise AI journey from pilot to production has shortened:** Writer believes the threshold for enterprise AI pilots has risen materially as technology and client familiarity has matured. Successful use cases should now demonstrate tangible business impact quickly, potentially within weeks/during pilots; making it easier for only visible ROI pilots to be scaled. **3) Strategic vision:** Writer sees the "agentic client journey" as an emerging enterprise AI category. They expect AI agents to increasingly connect functions that are traditionally separated across sales, marketing and servicing. Writer's longer-term opportunity is therefore not simply automating individual tasks, but orchestrating the full client journey through a continuous feedback loop between customer interactions and enterprise knowledge. **4) High ROI use cases in asset managers:** Market intelligence, portfolio workflows, RFP generation, portfolio commentary and client distribution. May also highlighted an end-to-end advisor/distribution workflow through Writer: pre-meeting prep, live meeting summarization, updating an investment thesis, portfolio commentary, RFP preparation, memo generation and recommended follow-up communication. **5) Keeping Enterprise brain dynamic:** Human-in-the-loop review and approval is the key, particularly for implicit knowledge or new information that may contradict the explicit knowledge already stored in the Enterprise Brain. Relatively innocuous context, such as preferences around formatting, can be learned automatically and can potentially be elevated into team memory if multiple people consistently provide the same preference. Overall, Enterprise Brain evolves through a combination of explicit enterprise knowledge, continuously learned implicit knowledge, and human governance.

Next product evolution: proactive agents-Writer's roadmap is moving toward "agents that build agents" and signal-driven automation. Instead of waiting for employees to initiate workflows, future agents are expected to monitor macro and micro signals, interpret business objectives, dynamically create or coordinate workflows, and involve employees primarily when human judgment is required. May indicated that this next generation model could come sometime in the next quarter or so.

DETAILS

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8 Sep 2025 - [Gen AI in Asset Management: Chat with Co-Founder & CEO of Daloopa- Key takeaways & Replay](#)

WRITER'S JOURNEY AND KEY TOPICS IN DISCUSSION

We hosted **May Habib, CEO & Co-Founder of Writer**, for the third session of our Gen AI in Asset Management Innovator Series Season 2. A key message from the discussion is that Writer sees the enterprise AI bottleneck shifting from raw model intelligence toward scalable execution. Its differentiation therefore rests less on having the single highest-performing foundation model and more on combining Palmyra models, domain-specific harnesses, Enterprise Brain, reusable Playbooks, enterprise connectors, embedded compliance and centralized governance into a system that businesses can deploy repeatedly at scale. We share below key insights from our discussion-

COMPANY AI JOURNEY AND POSITIONING SHIFT

Writer's technology roots pre-date the current generative AI cycle. The idea of Writer company initially emerged from establishment in machine translation and natural-language processing, where its founders were already experimenting with encoder-decoder architectures and early transformer models. Since its founding in 2020, the company has continued to develop and train proprietary models while expanding from language generation into a broader enterprise AI platform.

Writer today positions itself around enterprise-scale AI orchestration rather than standalone model access. Management argues that a major gap exists between what an advanced model can accomplish for an individual user and what an organization can deploy reliably across hundreds or thousands of employees. Writer attempts to bridge this gap through its proprietary models, agent-building environment, enterprise knowledge layer, workflow orchestration, compliance controls, connectors, and centralized governance. May also mentioned that Writer currently works with one-third of the Global 2000.

WRITER'S STRATEGIC FOCUS: AGENTIC CLIENT JOURNEY

Within financial services, Writer supports a broad range of workflows, including trade reconciliation and accounts payable, but has developed particular strength in front-office research, sales, marketing and distribution workflows. The platform aims to connect processes that historically sit across separate enterprise systems, sales enablement, marketing and compliance systems, using AI to manage the context and handoffs across the customer lifecycle. May highlighted that their long-term ambition is to automate the "agentic client journey", covering activities from prospecting and territory planning through meeting preparation, client engagement, follow-up, reporting and relationship management. Rather than targeting every end user as an agent builder, Writer expects functions such as sales operations and marketing operations to create and govern reusable agents that can then operate consistently across much larger distribution organizations.

WRITER'S ARCHITECTURE AND KEY DIFFERENTIATORS

Playbooks: Enterprise agents built for shared, scaled work — Writer refers to its reusable agents and workflows as Playbooks. A Playbook can coordinate multiple tasks, tools, enterprise data sources and approval steps into an end-to-end business workflow. Teams can build dozens or potentially thousands of Playbooks and distribute them through customized interfaces for different functions. Importantly, Playbooks can be triggered automatically rather than requiring users to initiate every task. A scheduled calendar meeting, new information in SharePoint or another business event can trigger a workflow such as meeting preparation or post-meeting follow-up. A single workflow could retrieve CRM records, collect previous meeting notes, conduct a client-risk assessment, generate a briefing, distribute it through Teams, archive outputs in SharePoint and prepare personalized client materials.

Enterprise Brain: turning organizational context into reusable AI knowledge — Enterprise Brain is Writer's enterprise knowledge and context layer. Explicit information can include product documentation, fund materials, brand/style guidelines, disclosures, compliance requirements and other corporate knowledge. This information is automatically made available to agents when relevant, reducing the need for employees to manually attach instructions or invoke separate compliance processes. Enterprise Brain can also accumulate implicit organizational knowledge from interactions between employees and Writer. Personal preferences can remain individual memories, while recurring guidance shared across multiple users may be elevated into team-level knowledge. For potentially material or conflicting information, Writer incorporates human review before promoting new knowledge into the wider enterprise context. Management sees this as a mechanism for capturing and scaling the practices of high-performing employees across organizations.

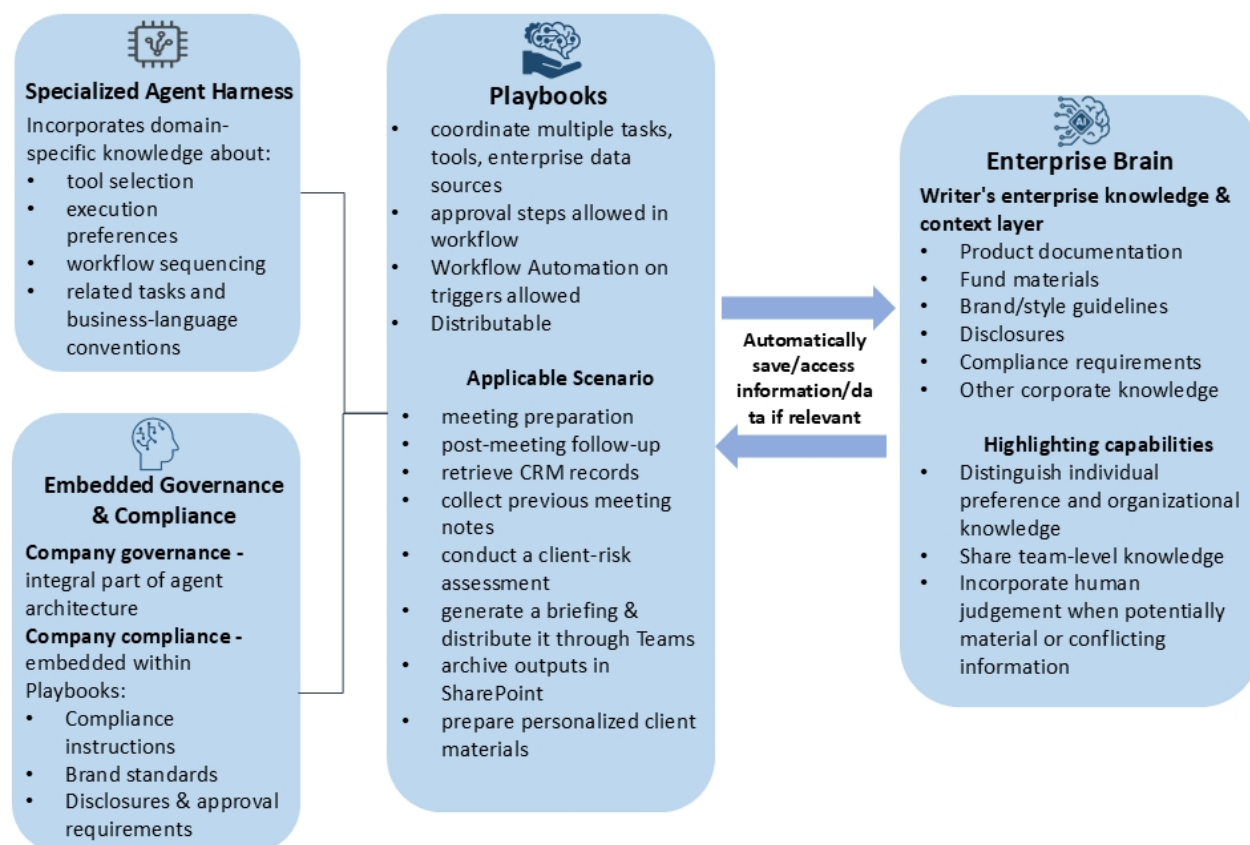
Specialized Agent Harness: differentiation beyond the model — Writer argues that enterprise AI performance increasingly depends on the harness or scaffolding surrounding the underlying model, not simply model intelligence. The harness incorporates domain-specific knowledge about tool selection, execution preferences, workflow sequencing, related tasks and

business-language conventions. May said its purpose-built harness can perform equivalent tasks 40% cheaper, 50% faster and 20% more accurately than less specialized approaches, according to Writer's own research cited during the session.

Embedded Governance and Compliance in Workflow — Governance is designed as an integral part of the agent architecture. Compliance instructions, brand standards, disclosures and approval requirements can be embedded directly within Playbooks rather than applied as a separate downstream review process. FINRA- or SEC-related requirements, for example, can become part of the workflow used to generate outputs. Human approvals can also be inserted at specific points. If content requires approval, the agent can identify an authorized reviewer through collaboration applications such as Teams or Slack, request sign-off and determine what to do if revisions are requested.

Palmyra X6: Writer's latest flagship model — Palmyra X6, is optimized specifically around enterprise front-office and go-to-market workflows rather than competing solely on generalized model benchmarks. Management highlighted capabilities across sub-agents, grounding and retrieval, MCP/tool use, content generation, brand and voice, image analysis/generation, presentation creation, and model/system awareness. Writer characterized X6 as "faster, cheaper, better" for its targeted workloads, claiming improvements over Opus-class frontier models with average \$0.12 cost per finish task. This is 52% less than their last generation model. The model was also able to work non-stop for 8hrs on a single objective, unattended. Overall, their model is 9.4x cheaper than Claude Opus 4.8 with \$3.5 blended cost per million tokens for a typical 3:1 input to output mix. Cost efficiency comes from lower token usage enabled by the specialized harness, which understands typical workflows, required tools and task sequences. Do note, users do get the optionality to chose other frontier models as well through Writer if that is what Enterprises choose.

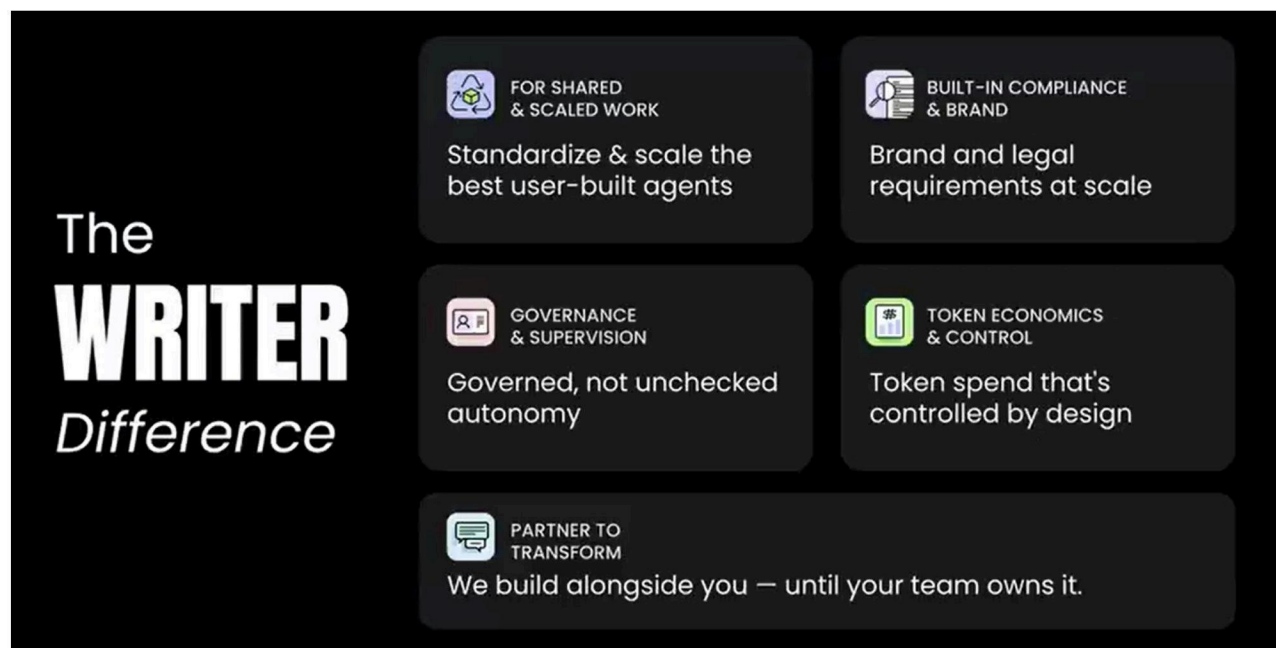
EXHIBIT 1: **Writer - The Enterprise AI agentic harness**



Source: Bernstein analysis

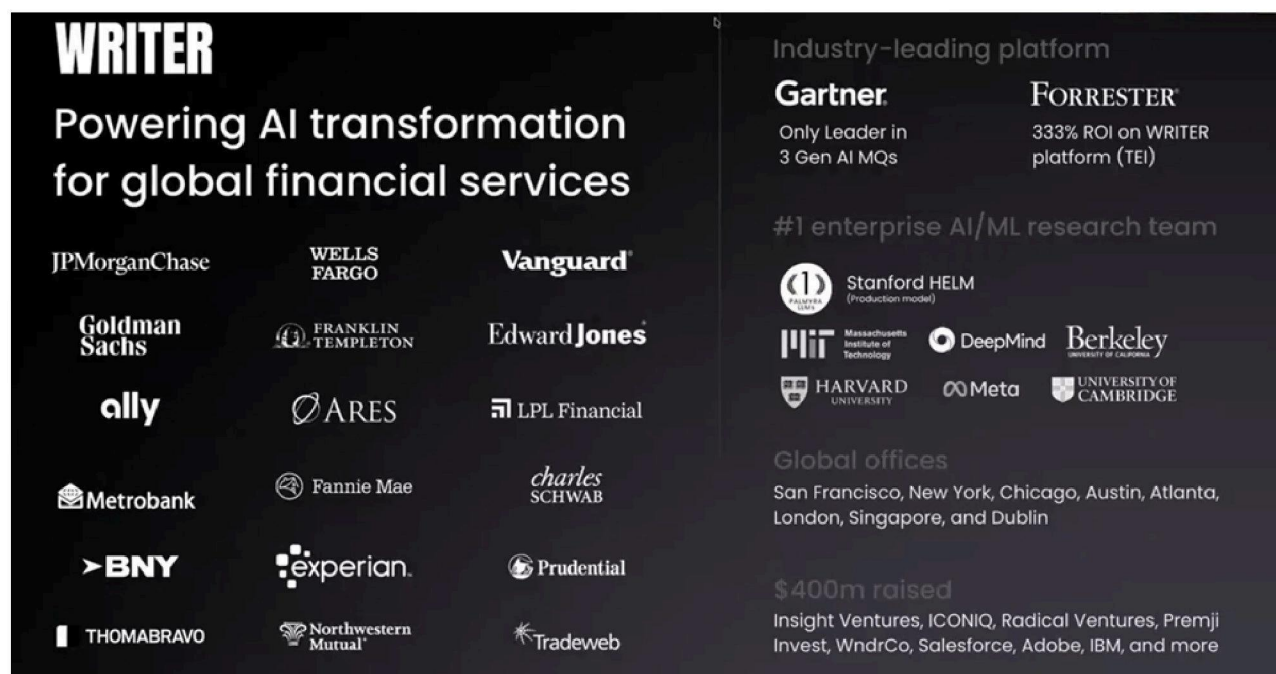
WRITER DEMO

EXHIBIT 2: **The Writer Difference- Shared/Scaled work which is governed, compliant and optimized for token economics**



Source: Writer

EXHIBIT 3: **A third of the global 2000 are Writer's customers**



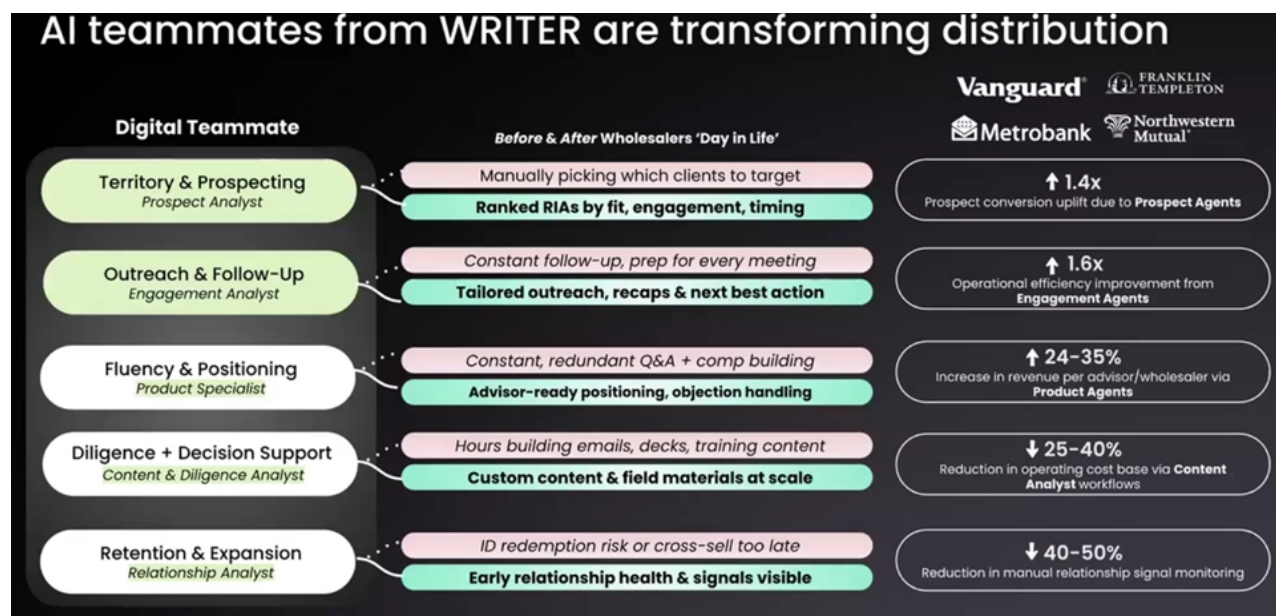
Source: Writer

EXHIBIT 4: **Writer is specifically well-known for sales and marketing, though Writer works with many prominent financial services companies too**



Source: Writer

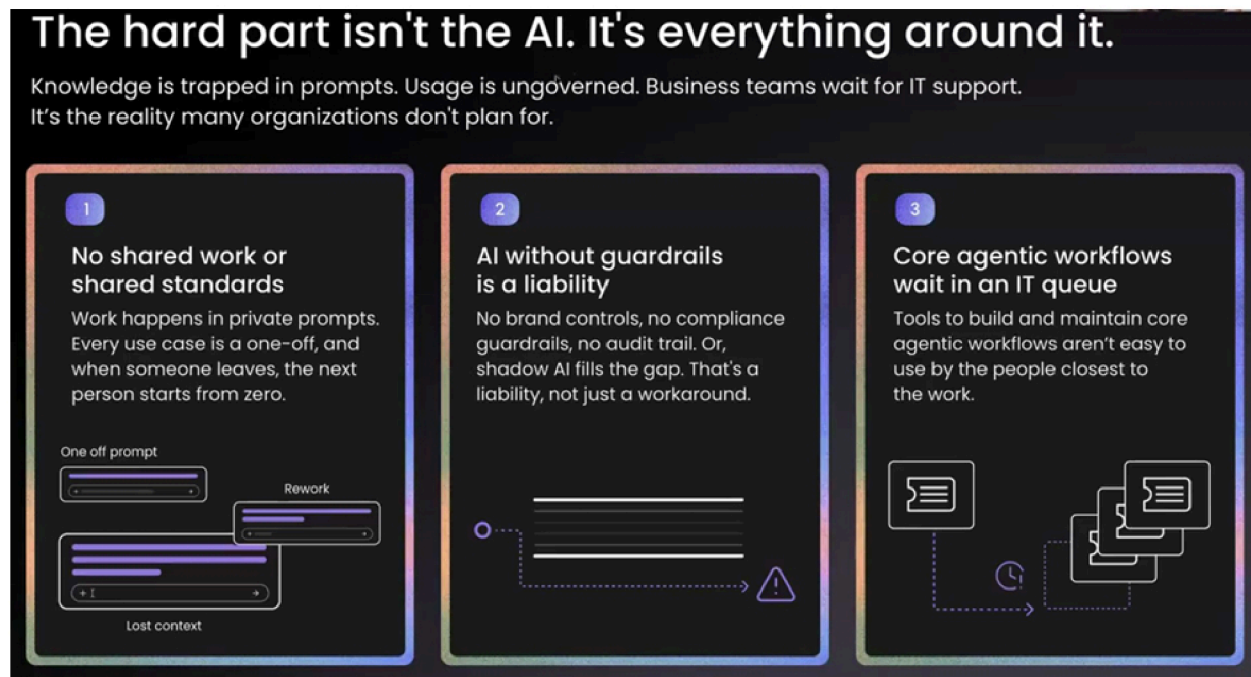
EXHIBIT 5: **Writer's transformation to distribution through its different agents like prospect agent, engagement agent, product specialist, content & diligence analyst and relationship analyst**



Source: Writer

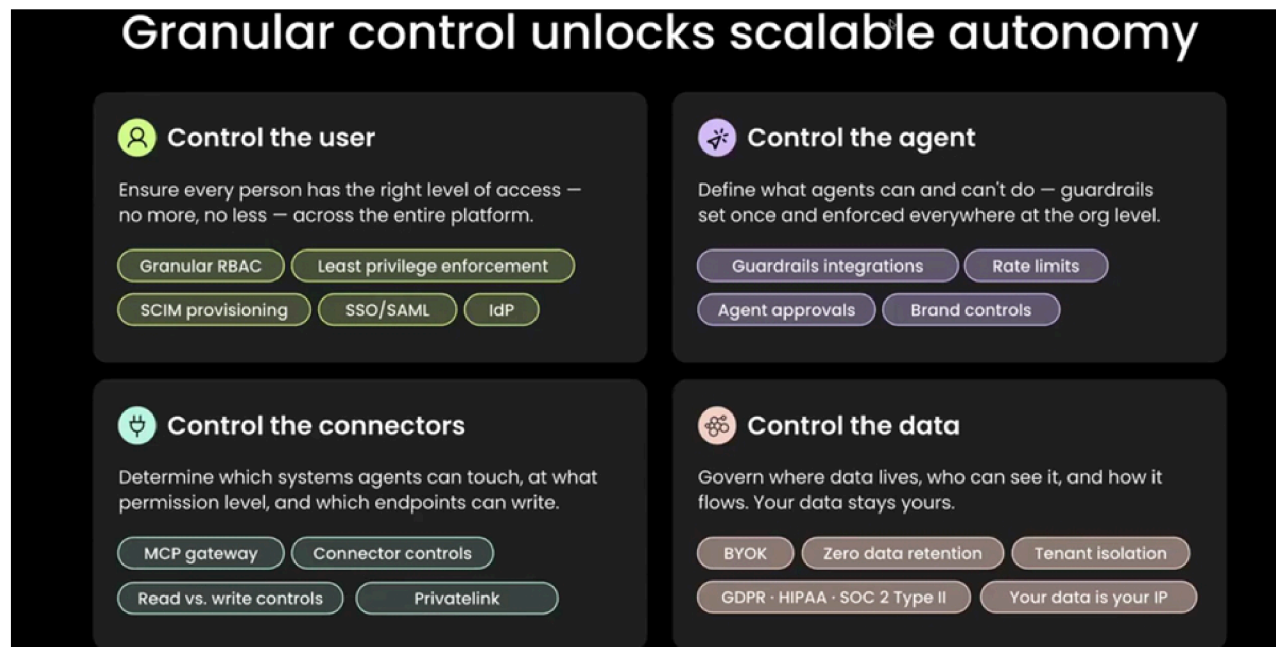
EXHIBIT 6: The real world challenges while introducing AI agents into workflows of financial services and Writer has perfectly solve them with the comprehensive design in architecture

Writer solves for the hard part in AI by creating proper guardrails, shared standards and core agentic workflows which are not depending on IT queue

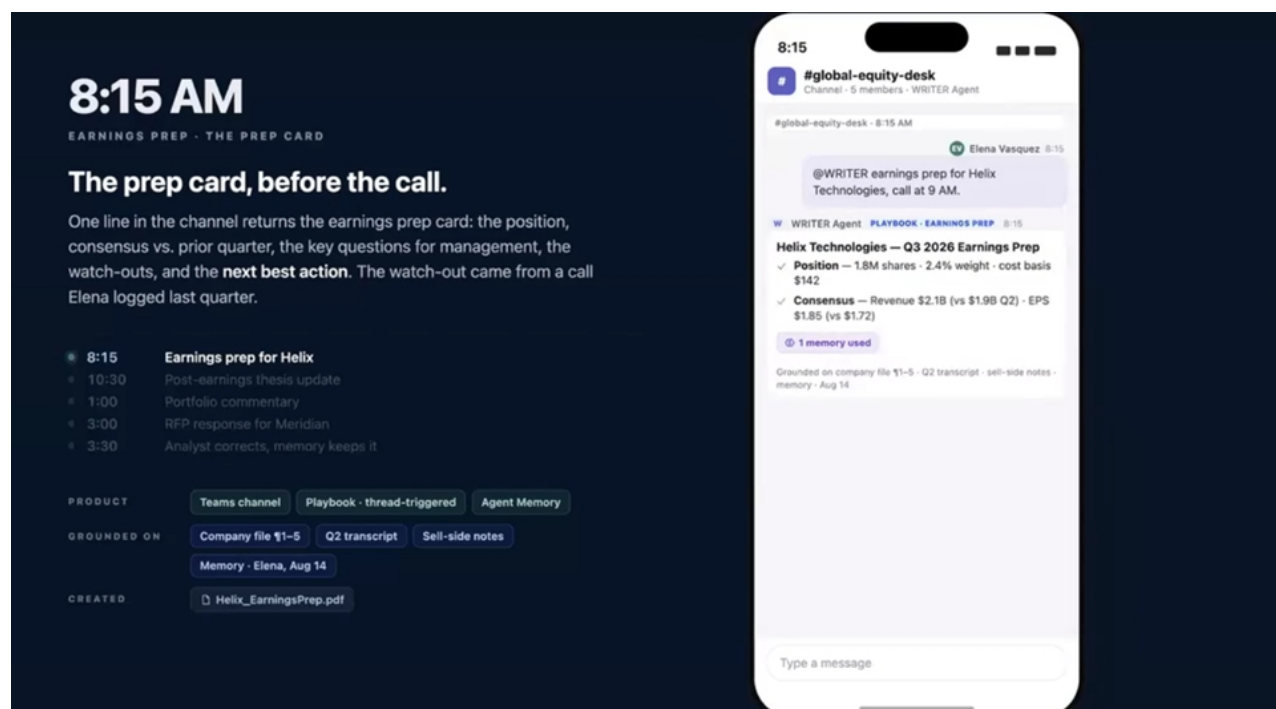


Source: Writer

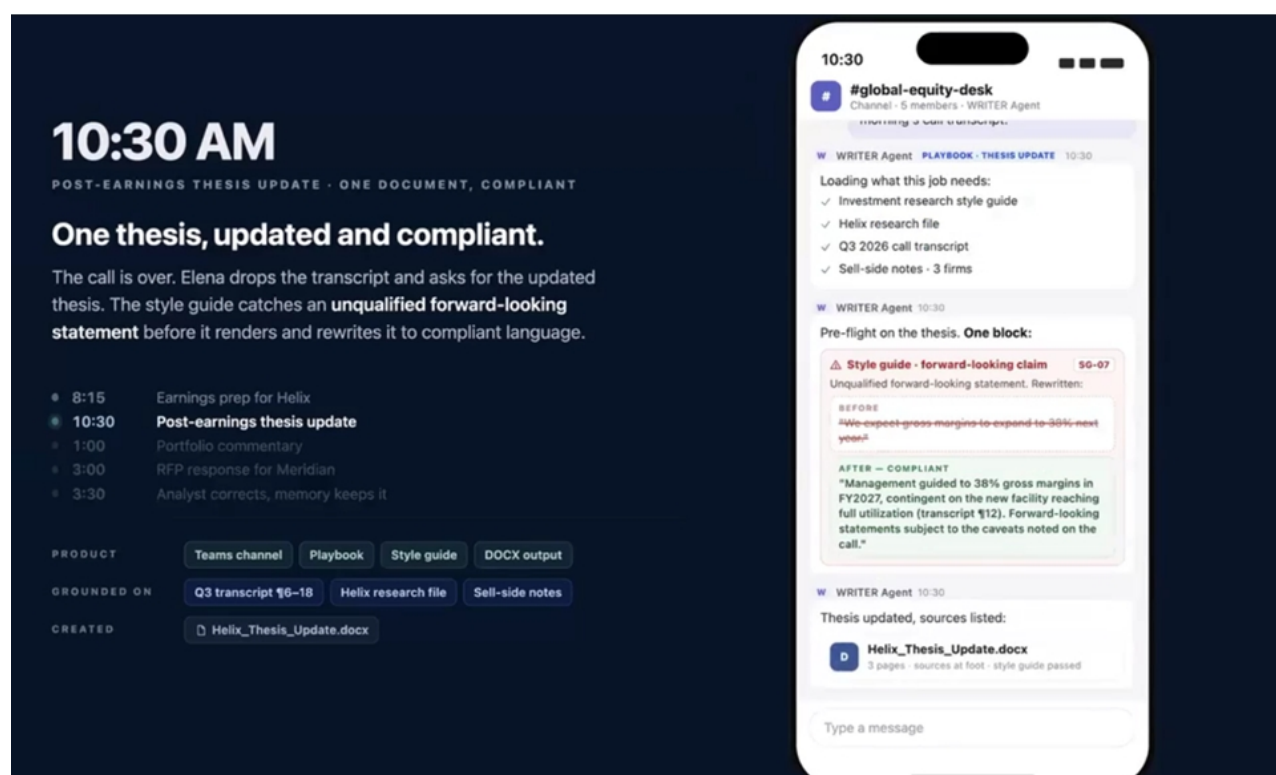
EXHIBIT 7: Governance and control features of Writer



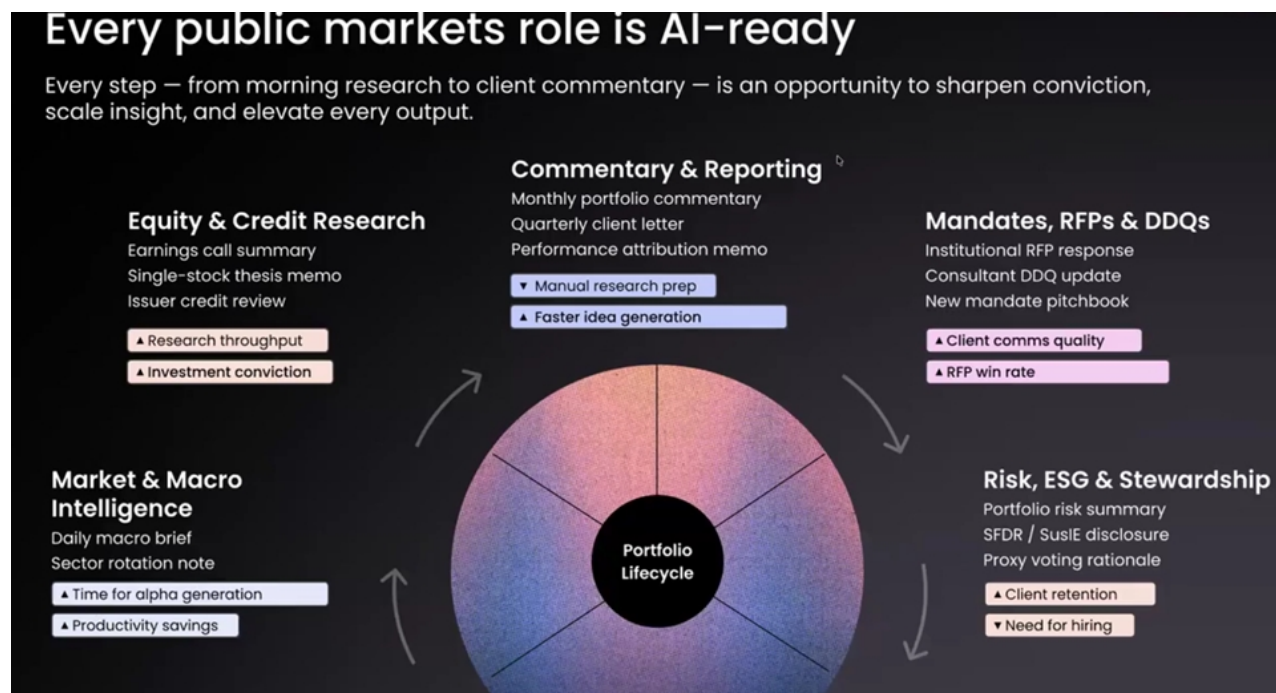
Source: Writer

EXHIBIT 8: **A day with Writer Agent: Simple chat through Slack/Teams. Example of day starting with earnings prep**

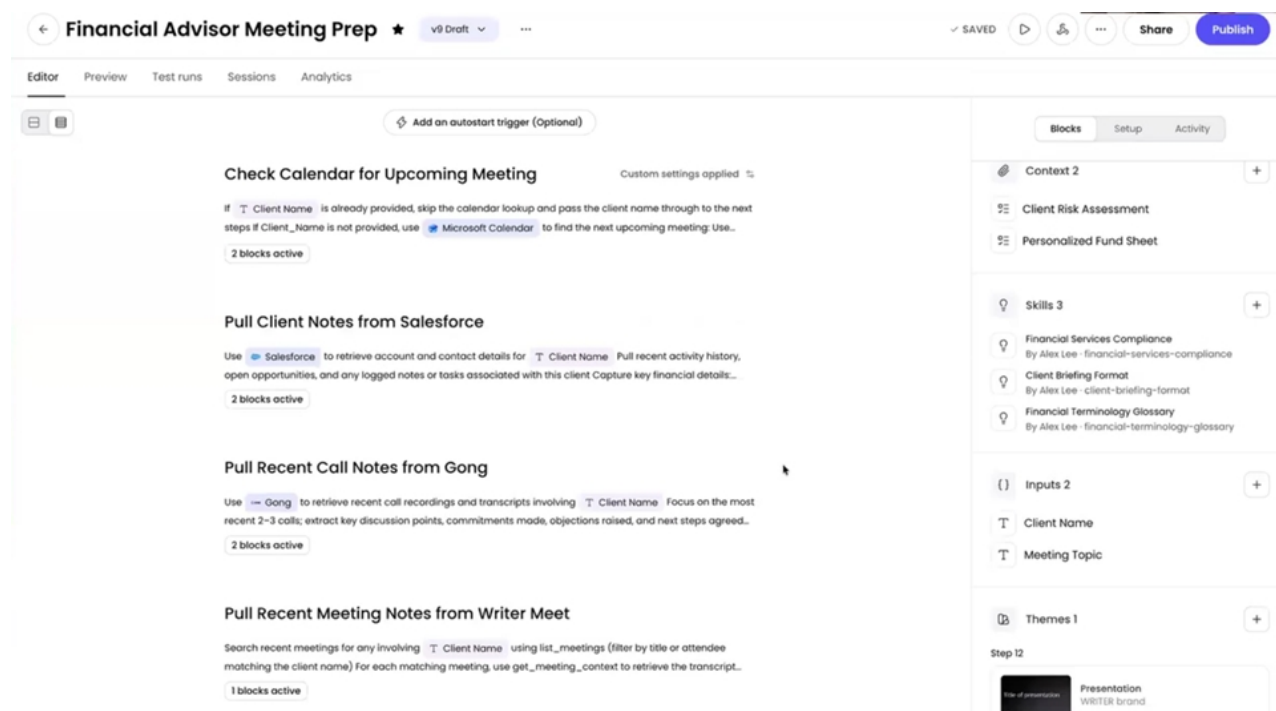
Source: Writer

EXHIBIT 9: **Writer's agent is able to be there in the meeting, providing a transcript and updating the thesis after an earnings call, with all tasks clearly scheduled**

Source: Writer

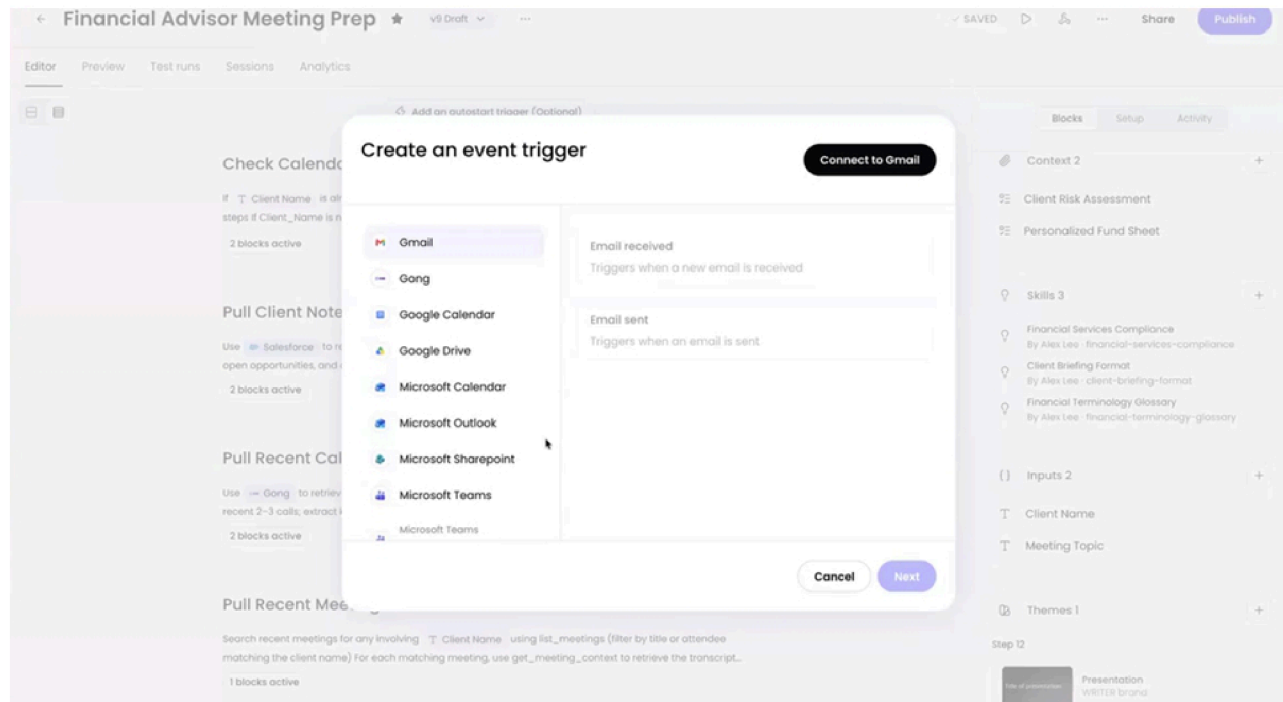
EXHIBIT 10: **Writer has developed the capability to cover the full life-cycle of portfolio**

Source: Writer

EXHIBIT 11: **Writer's reusable agents and workflows, known as Playbook, which is centrally built, standardized, triggered and governed rather than recreated independently through individual prompts**

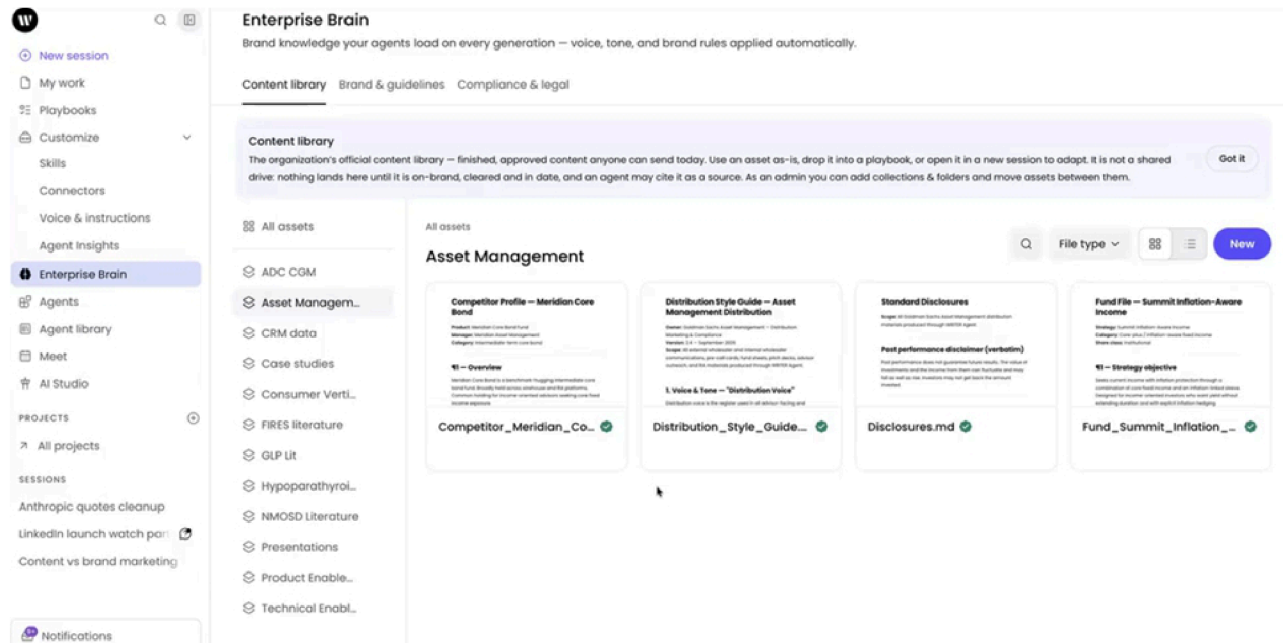
Source: Writer

EXHIBIT 12: In Playbook, user can add triggers as they want. The screenshot showcases the event triggers, such as calendar meeting and Sharepoint event



Source: Writer

EXHIBIT 13: 'Enterprise Brain' is core to Writer's offering - this is the organization level voice, tone, rules that are automatically applied to all playbooks



Source: Writer

EXHIBIT 14: Importantly, the compliance and legal rules are put in by compliance and legal teams, and the rules are embedded in the Enterprise Brain

Enterprise Brain
Brand knowledge your agents load on every generation — voice, tone, and brand rules applied automatically.

Content library Brand & guidelines Compliance & legal

Benefits without the material risks alongside them.
Performance without the required periods and basis.
Predictions or projections of investment results.

Required disclosures
Inserted automatically on the trigger

Disclosure	Applies when
Material risk disclosure	Any product benefit is described.
Performance basis & period	Any performance figure appears.

Writing rules
How compliant copy is actually written
Balance is per-communication — a risk page elsewhere doesn't cure an unbalanced piece.
Retail language avoids jargon; institutional pieces still carry the risk statement.
Retain every version with its approval.

Approval workflow
What a human must sign before it ships

Trigger	Routes to	SLA
Retail communication	→ Registered principal	1 business day

Source: Writer

EXHIBIT 15: Example of compliance review assignment to agent

May's post-Zoom mtg playbook v2 Draft

Editor Preview Test runs Sessions Analytics

Transcribe and Analyze
Transcribe the provided meeting recording. Meeting Recordings. Analyze the results for strategic opportunities, and next steps. Identify their roles and the context of their contributions.

Assign approver

Assign approvers

APPROVERS REVIEW QUESTION NEXT STEPS

What should happen when changes are requested?

- Agent revises and resubmits**
The agent updates the output based on the reviewer's feedback and resubmits it.
- Pause for manual review**
The person running the playbook reviews the feedback and decides what happens next.

Cancel Previous Save

Draft Content
Based on the analysis of the meeting, perform narrative summary of the meeting, including key points.

Generate HTML Dashboard
Generate an interactive HTML dashboard with any people mentioned by the customer / prospect.

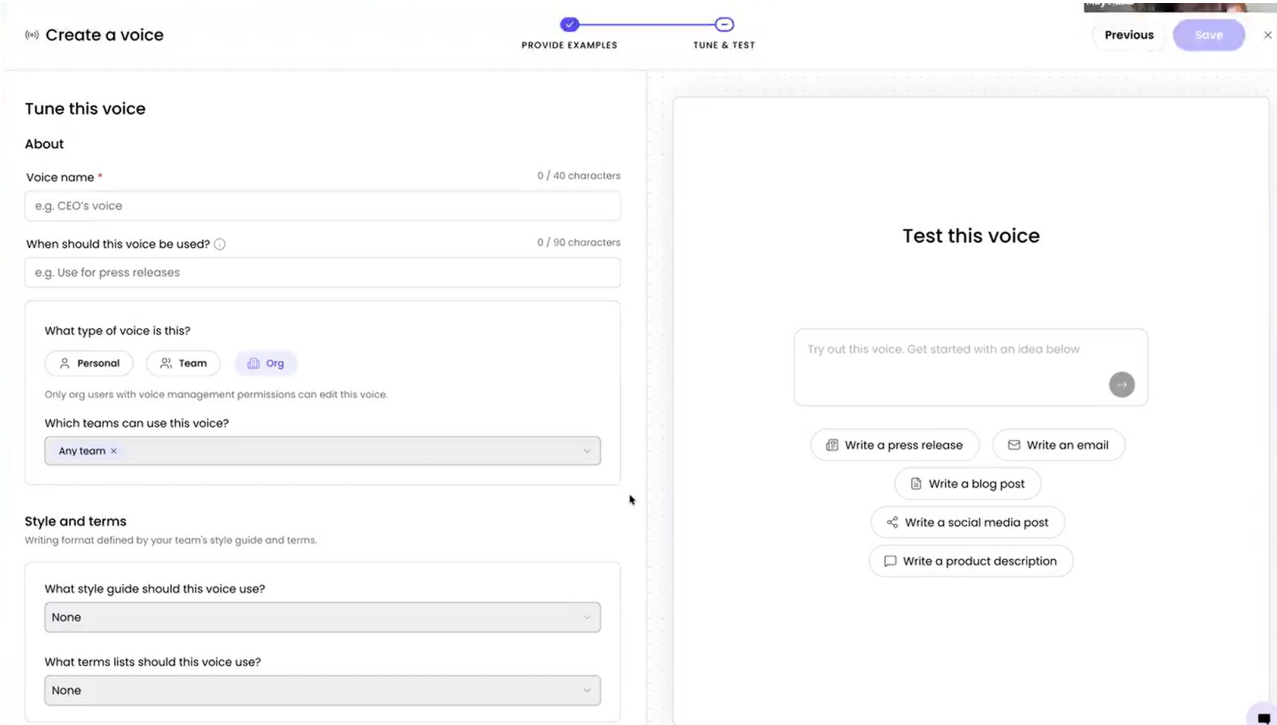
Final Delivery
Provide the user with the link to the generated HTML dashboard created in the previous steps as the final completion criteria.

Connectors 0
Context 0
Skills 4
Branded Interactive Slides
writer-slides
Brand Guideline Skill Creator
WRITER Brand Guidelines

Inputs 1
Meeting Recordings
Themes 0

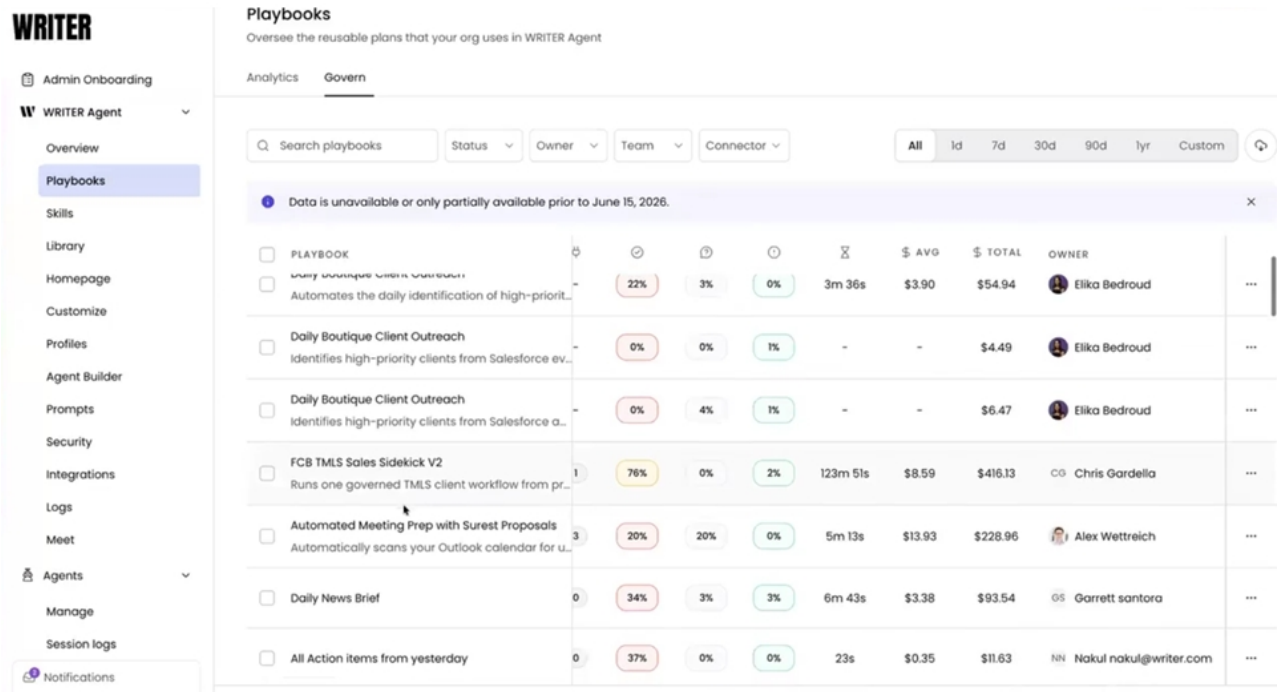
Source: Writer

EXHIBIT 16: **Writer offers personalized voice agent to sound like different users rather than AI**



Source: Writer

EXHIBIT 17: **Governance view of Playbooks enable users to better control the token consumption and better allocate the assignments**



Source: Writer

EXHIBIT 18: **Writer partners with organizations to drive adoption, broaden AI competencies and transform at scale**

We partner to build your AI-native organization

01 — Drive immediate adoption
Executive training, kickstart sessions, and dedicated office hours.

02 — Broaden AI competencies
On-demand WRITER Passport and WRITER Academy courses, live peer sessions, and live hackathons.

03 — Transform at scale
Monthly WRITER @ Work product webinars, Champions peer community, and WRITER Catalyst champion enablement.

WRITER MARS

WRITER FRANKLIN TEMPLETON

WRITER Qualcomm

Source: Writer

USE CASES IN FINANCIAL SERVICES**HIGH ROI APPLICATIONS IN ASSET MANAGEMENT RESEARCH AND PORTFOLIO WORKFLOWS**

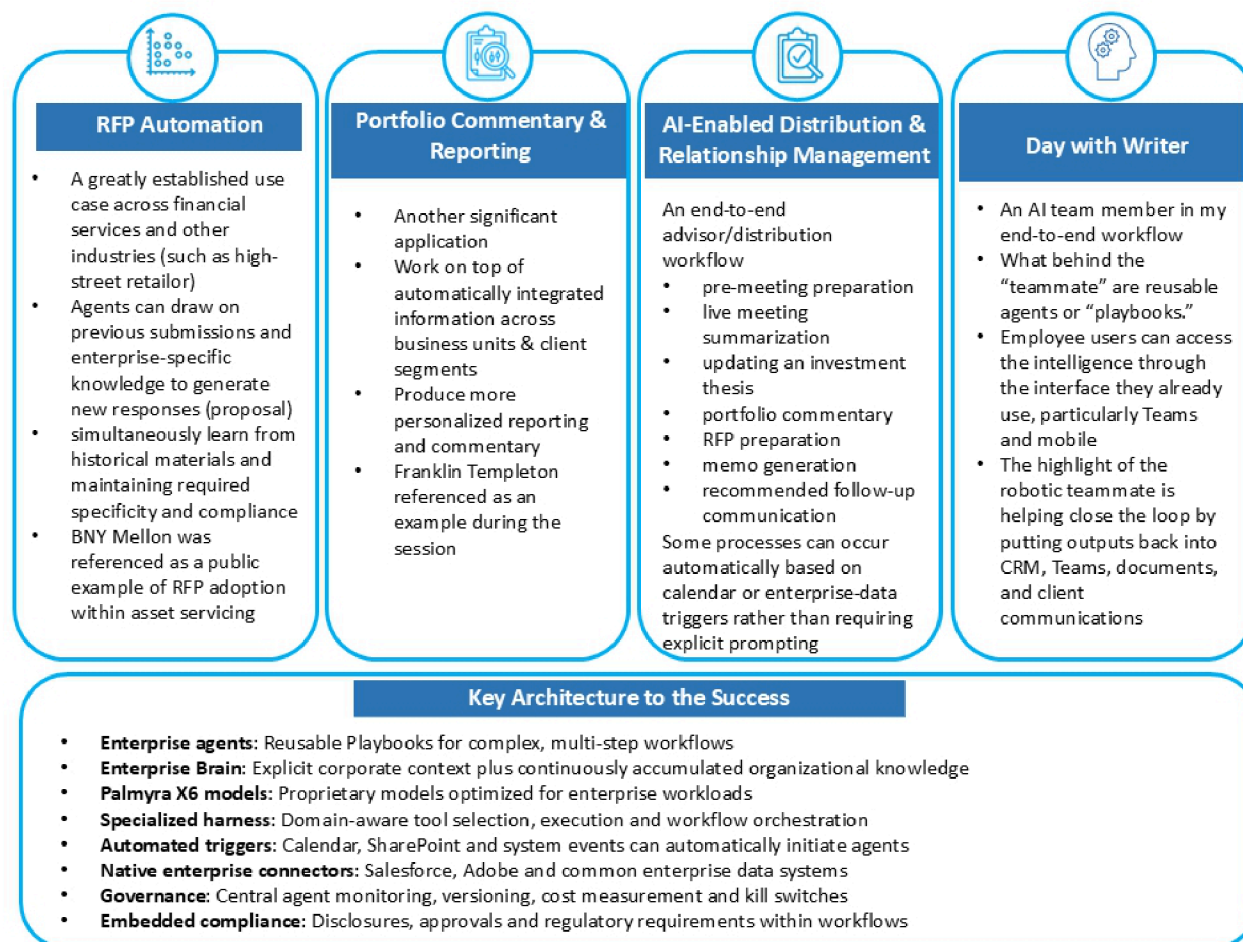
For investment analysts and portfolio managers, management identified market and macro intelligence and portfolio-related workflows as high-ROI applications. Agents can automatically gather information from integrated research/data sources and distribute recurring intelligence to investment teams. Playbooks developed by technically advanced users can subsequently be shared across a broader investment organization, helping institutionalize successful AI workflows.

RFP Automation — Writer highlighted RFP generation as an established use case across financial services and other industries. Agents can draw on previous submissions and enterprise-specific knowledge to generate new responses, while learning from historical materials and maintaining required specificity and compliance. BNY Mellon was referenced as a public example of RFP adoption within asset servicing.

Portfolio Commentary and Reporting — Portfolio commentary and reporting represent another significant application. Writer can integrate information across business units and client segments to produce more personalized reporting and commentary, with Franklin Templeton referenced as an example during the session.

AI-Enabled Distribution and Relationship Management — The live demonstration illustrated an end-to-end advisor/distribution workflow: pre-meeting preparation, live meeting summarization, updating an investment thesis, portfolio commentary, RFP preparation, memo generation and recommended follow-up communication. Some processes can occur automatically based on calendar or enterprise-data triggers rather than requiring explicit prompting.

Another powerful tooling in this use case is Writer's Voice capability, which can learn communication patterns at the corporate, team and individual levels. May described using historical transcripts to reproduce the communication style of advisors, allowing AI-generated client communications to remain closer to both individual and corporate communication standards.

EXHIBIT 19: **The high ROI use cases in Writer**

Source: Writer, Bernstein Analysis

KEY QUESTIONS**Q. HOW IS ENTERPRISE BRAIN UPDATED AND KEPT DYNAMIC?**

One critical part of its update process is human-in-the-loop review and approval, particularly for implicit knowledge or new information that may contradict the explicit knowledge already stored in the Enterprise Brain. Writer has built that review process directly into the end-user experience. Different types of implicit knowledge can be treated differently. Things that are relatively innocuous, such as preferences around formatting, wording, or style, can be learned automatically. They may first become part of an individual user's personal memory. If multiple people consistently provide the same correction or preference, that knowledge can potentially be elevated into team memory. This creates an opportunity to amplify the knowledge of an organization's best performers. Meanwhile, some corrections or insights may be significant enough that they require governance before being promoted more broadly. In those cases, the Enterprise Brain administrator or team administrator can review and approve the knowledge before it is incorporated into the shared Enterprise Brain. So the Enterprise Brain evolves through a combination of explicit enterprise knowledge, continuously learned implicit knowledge, and human governance

Q.PACE THE FRONTIER OR PUSH THE FRONTIER?

May believes some of the recent talk about pacing the frontier is more pre-IPO shenanigans and feels that it was not a model training failure. She does believe there should be some regulations/guardrails for model training, but Writer continues to push the frontier on the application/deployment layer.

Q.WHAT ARE ENTERPRISES TRYING TO OPTIMIZING FOR?

May highlighted it is visible/tangible results through the use of AI which they are seeing on their customers. Earlier IT was buying, but now business is leading to buy the AI solutions. IT is clearly concerned about security and data, but business is really interested in expanding powerful agents across the investment processes.

Q. HOW DOES WRITER PRICE ITS PLATFORM?

Writer's pricing combines platform fee per user access with token-based consumption. May described the platform fee as effectively a token pre-commit, while users can be segmented into heavier paid users and lighter users. The consumption model is intended to scale with actual agent utilization and business outcomes. The platform provides granular visibility into token economics, including which users run particular agents, cost per playbook run and overall utilization. May argued that this transparency becomes increasingly important as enterprise AI consumption scales. May also cited a Forrester use case, showing 333% ROI within the first six months and said enterprise renewal rates exceed 95%. Writer does not charge based on strict limits to the size of Enterprise Brain or the number of Playbooks. Management said Enterprise Brain can extend into terabytes and organizations can operate thousands of Playbooks. For deployments of roughly 150–200 users, May indicated an investment of approximately US\$500K–US\$1 million, depending on use cases and the degree of agent autonomy.

Q. MOVING FROM AI PILOTS TO SCALED DEPLOYED?

Writer's view has shifted toward requiring very rapid, measurable business impact as enterprise AI literacy has improved, and agent technology has matured. Writer believes organizations should no longer need extended pilots merely to validate whether an application can create value. May stated that strong use cases should begin demonstrating ROI within approximately one week (or during the pilot), citing Metro Bank as an example where deposit growth occurred during the pilot itself. Where a pilot fails to generate early value, Enterprises should question whether simply extending it for several months would materially change the outcome.

Q. HOW DOES WRITER CREATE PERSONALIZED "VOICE"?

Writer supports a nested voice architecture ranging from Writer's default style through corporate and channel-specific voices to individual employee voices. Corporate communication patterns can be derived from approved public and enterprise materials, while individual styles can be learned from historical transcripts and communications. Organizations can therefore define different communication standards depending on channel. The personalized voice layer applies to AI-generated insights, collateral and communications regardless of whether the underlying workflow uses Palmyra or a supported third-party model, because Voice sits within Writer's harness.

Q. HOW WILL THE ENTERPRISE AI MARKET EVOLVE?

May expects segmentation to emerge by both customer size and business workflow, with enterprise, mid-market and SMB requirements remaining substantially different. Writer intends to focus on a new category around the agentic client relationship or client journey, spanning sales, marketing and other customer-facing activities that depend heavily on enterprise context. Management also expects conventional functional boundaries to blur as agents increasingly coordinate activities that currently sit across separate sales, marketing and service organizations. If May has to build her company again today, she would only have two functions - innovate & build, sell/services with only three layers - ICs, managers and execs. The longer-term objective is to create continuous feedback loops between customer interactions, enterprise knowledge and externally delivered information.

Q. WHICH SECTORS AND REGIONS ARE GROWING FASTEST FOR WRITER?

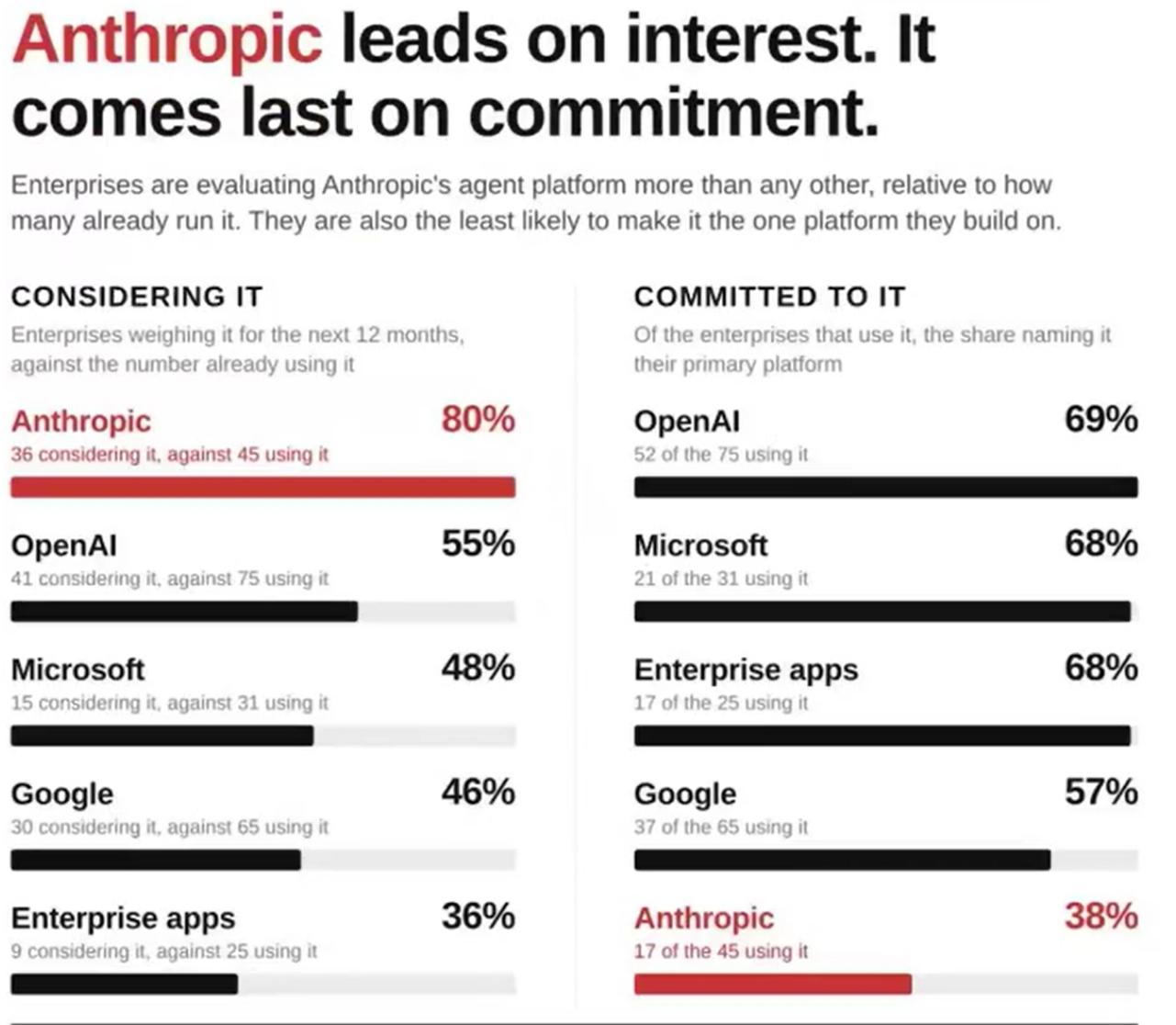
May identified wealth and asset management and consumer packaged goods (CPG) as Writer's fastest-growing verticals globally. In EMEA, retail and consumer applications are also expanding rapidly, partly because margin compression is putting pressure on Enterprises to improve operational efficiency. Financial-services demand remains particularly concentrated around major financial centers, while multinational CPG clients create a more globally distributed opportunity.

Q.WHAT'S THE NEXT GENERATION MODEL FOR WRITER?

Writer's next major development is "agents that build agents," alongside more intent-driven and signal-based autonomous systems. The company wants system to quickly understand how a business operates, monitor relevant macro and micro signals and dynamically orchestrate workflows around desired outcomes. The intended shift is from user-prompted agents toward proactive agents. Rather than employees repeatedly initiating tasks, agents would continuously operate against predefined objectives and proactively escalate issues requiring human judgment. May described this functionality as relatively near term,

potentially in the next quarter or two.

EXHIBIT 20: **May shared interest recent article which shows Anthropic leads on interest but last on committment from Enterprises**

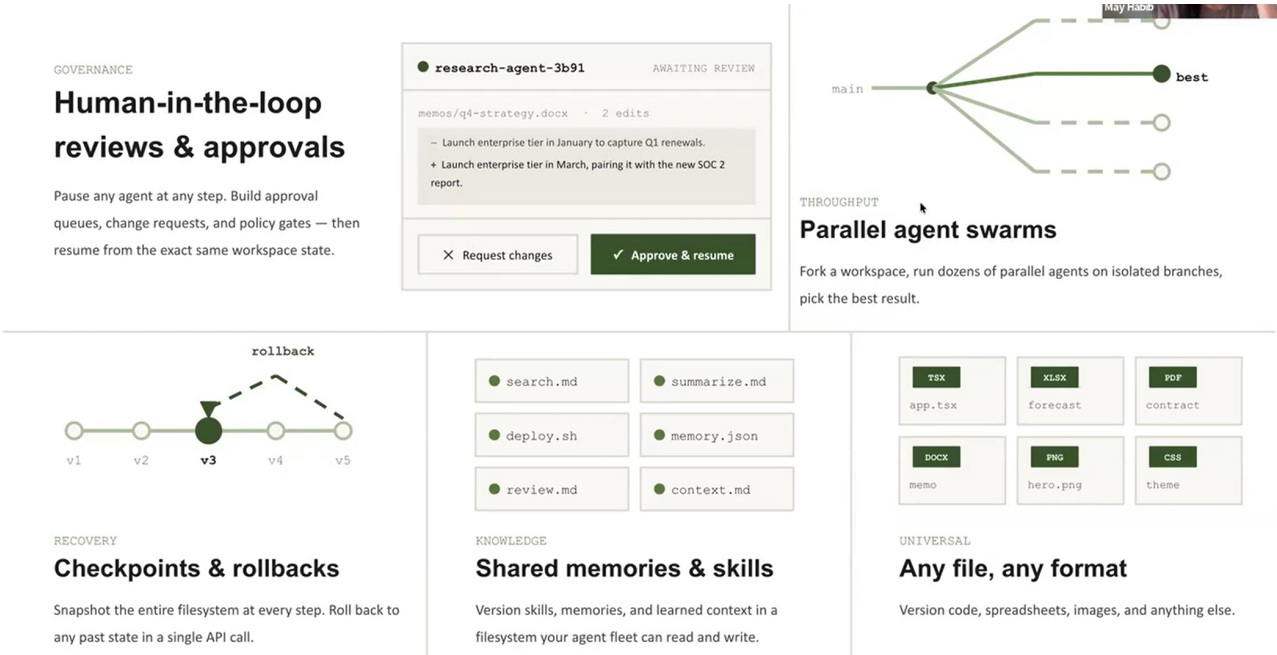


VENTUREBEAT RESEARCH

VB Pulse agentic orchestration survey, August 2026. 169 qualified respondents at organizations with 100 or more employees; 121 named platforms they are considering. Amazon Bedrock Agents is left out: 15 enterprises use it, too few to report a percentage. Enterprise apps was fielded as one answer choice covering Salesforce Agentforce, ServiceNow,

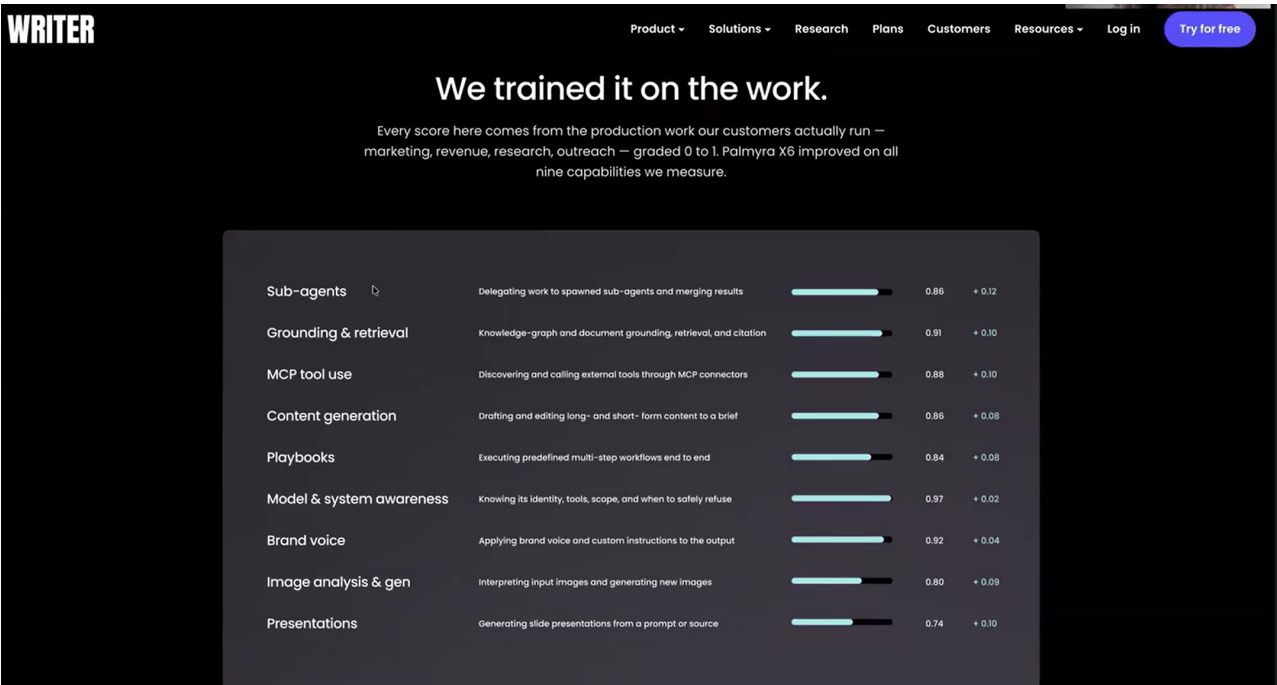
Source: Venturebeat research, Writer

EXHIBIT 21: **Enterprise brain - With versions and states with human-in-loop controls/reviews. Dynamic update of brain but admin needs to review and approve**

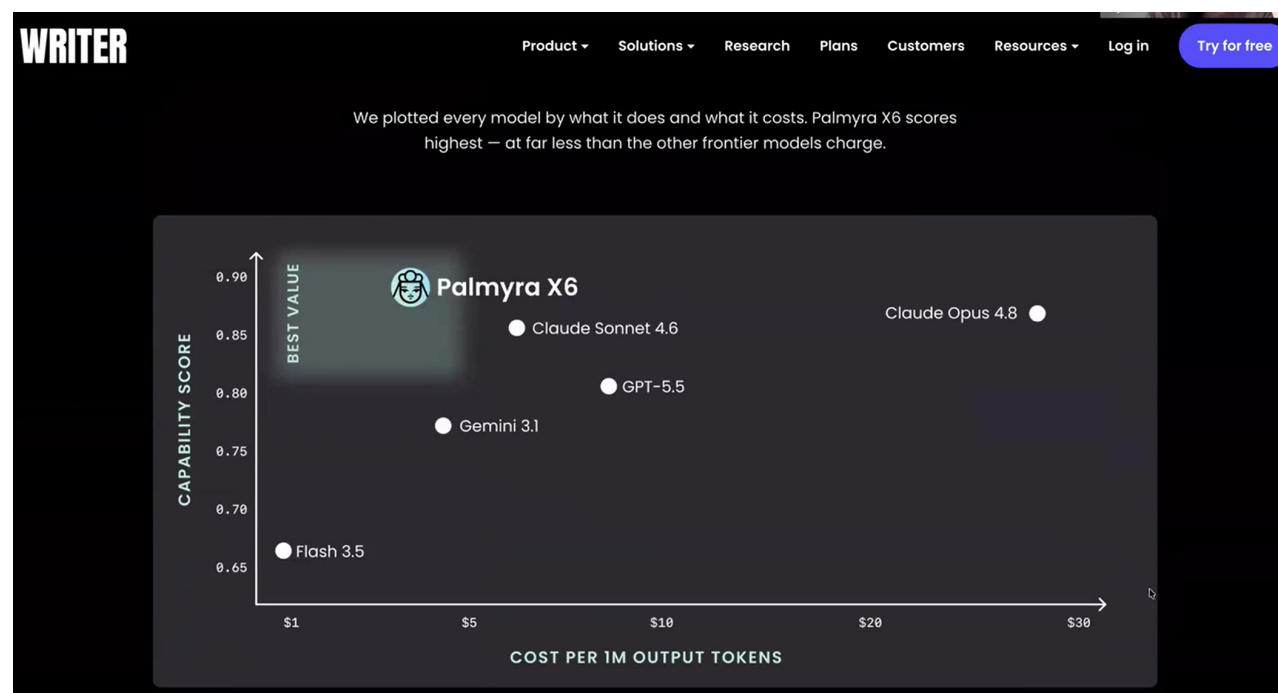


Source: Writer

EXHIBIT 22: **Writer’s Palmyra X6 improved all tasks compared vs. Opus class models**



Source: Writer

EXHIBIT 23: **Writer's model is best value for money vs. frontier model in terms of quality vs. cost**

Source: Writer

We acknowledge the contributions of Rui Shi to this report

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